Driving Growth of the Interview Feature

7 Oct 2026

Product Strategy Proposal

Company: Product Space **Candidate:** Samay Thakur

1. Executive Summary

Core thesis. Learners do not return for content; they return for progress and access. An interview becomes a recurring habit when it is a **Watch** → **Practise** → **Track** unit tied to the learner's target role, and it becomes trusted when every guest and every claim can be verified.

Three bets, in priority order

1. **Interview-to-practice loop.** After each interview, the learner answers the same question the guest was asked, then compares their answer with the practitioner's. This gives viewers a reason to come back after watching.
2. **Role-based discovery first, then a weekly cadence.** A personalised shelf (for example, "Interviews for APM roles at product companies") first, followed by a fixed weekly release, so there is a reason to return every week.
3. **A built-in credibility system.** Verified guests, a standard interview format, a "What they actually asked" summary and visible ratings, so trust is designed into the product instead of claimed.

North-star metric: Weekly Returning Interview Learners (WRIL), meaning users who watch at least 60% of an interview, or attempt an interview-linked practice question, in a given week and have engaged with an interview in any earlier week. The engagement threshold is an initial measurement hypothesis and should be calibrated against actual completion curves once baseline data is available.

Assumptions. I have not seen the product or its data. I treat the "Interview feature" as recorded or live conversations with practising product managers and hiring leaders, on a platform built around PM interview readiness. All numeric targets are hypotheses to be checked against a baseline in week 1, not claims about current performance.

2. Diagnosis: Why Interviews May Not Bring Users Back Yet

Before choosing tactics, I would name the likely causes. These are hypotheses based on how learning content usually behaves; the first 30 days (Section 10) are designed to test them.

Likely cause	What the user experiences	Answer in this plan
D1. Passive consumption	"I watched it. Now what?" Nothing prompts a return visit.	Practice loop after every interview (Section 6)
D2. No rhythm	Interviews appear irregularly, so there is no "this week" to come back for.	Weekly series with a fixed slot (Section 6)
D3. Trust gap	"Is this advice current, and does it apply to my target company and level?"	Credibility system (Section 7)
D4. No personal path	Interviews sit in a library, unconnected to the learner's goal.	Role-based shelf and prep path (Sections 5 and 6)

3. Target Users and Their Needs

Given Product Space's focus on PM learning and interview readiness, I would initially prioritise users with an interview coming up. Urgency drives frequency, and frequency is what makes a feature recurring.

Segment	What they need	Why interviews help
A. Campus aspirants (final-year students; APM and intern roles) **[Primary]**	Know what "good" looks like, reduce guesswork and build confidence before a first PM interview.	Real questions and answers from people who have just been through the process.
B. Career switchers (engineers and analysts with 1 to 5 years of experience) **[Primary]**	A credible path into PM and a way to position past experience.	Stories from people who made the same switch.
C. Early-career PMs (upskilling) **[Secondary]**	Learn how senior people think about trade-offs, prioritisation and stakeholders.	Context that courses rarely give.

Why A and B first. They have a clear deadline (placements, applications), are actively looking for insider perspectives, and have a stronger immediate need for interview preparation. Segment C is valuable for brand and long-term retention, but it is a weaker initial acquisition engine.

Job to be done: "Help me understand what hiring managers actually look for, so I stop guessing and walk into my interview prepared."

4. Value Proposition

Passive video is cheap to watch and easy to forget. The interview feature must offer something a blog post, a YouTube video or a course lesson cannot.

Pillar	What the learner gets	Why it is hard to copy
Insider signal	What was actually asked, what the interviewer scored, and the common mistakes.	Needs access to real practitioners and hiring managers.
Role-model proof	A believable path, for example "engineer to PM at a startup in under a year."	Needs a community and an alumni network.
Applied practice	The same question to answer yourself, then compare.	Needs product design, not just content.

Value proposition: Learn how product leaders think and hire, then practise on the same questions, all in one place.

5. Distribution and Discovery Strategy

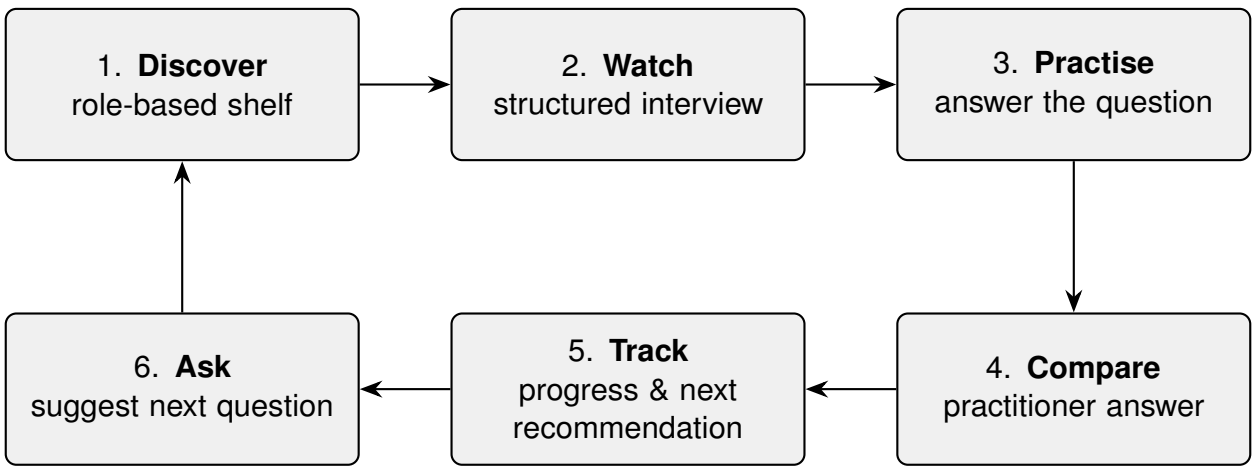
Principle: start where users already are (inside the product), then widen outwards through channels where each interview is reused many times.

Channel	Execution	Priority
In-product surfaces	A role-based shelf on the home screen; a "See how a PM answered this" link inside lessons, case studies and practice questions; a recommendation straight after sign-up.	**P0**
Guest co-distribution	Every guest receives a ready-to-post kit (three clips, a caption and a tracked link). Guests share with their own networks, which brings borrowed credibility and reach.	**P0**
Short clips	One interview becomes five or six clips (30 to 60 seconds) for LinkedIn, Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts, each ending with a "watch the full interview" link.	**P1**
Search (SEO)	Landing pages per company and question (for example, "PM interview at a fintech: what is actually asked"), with transcript excerpts and the sign-up step placed before the full interview.	**P1**
Email and WhatsApp digest	A weekly note: "This week's interview plus one practice question."	**P1**

Why this order. In-product placement and guest co-distribution cost the least and reach people who are already qualified (existing users and the guests' own PM-adjacent audiences). Clips and SEO need more content and more time to compound, so they follow.

6. Engagement and Retention Loops

The aim is to create reasons to return that do not depend on push notifications.



Loop	How it works	Retention effect
L1. Learn, practise, get feedback (core)	Each interview ends with the question the guest was asked. The learner answers, then compares with the practitioner's answer and a short rubric.	Gives a reason to come back after watching.
L2. Weekly series	A fixed release (for example, "Hiring Room" every Thursday) with a consistent format and a reminder the evening before.	Builds a weekly habit and anticipation.
L3. Community questions	Users submit and upvote questions for upcoming guests. The top three are asked on air and the asker is credited.	Investment: people return to see their question answered.
L4. Personal queue and streak	"Your prep path": the next three interviews for the learner's target role, with a light weekly streak.	Progress and variable reward.

How L1 works in version 1 (no heavy engineering). The learner writes or outlines a two-minute answer, then sees the guest's answer and a four-point rubric (structure, user focus, trade-offs, metrics) and self-scores. Version 2 adds AI-generated feedback once self-score data shows what learners find useful. This keeps the first release small enough to test within weeks.

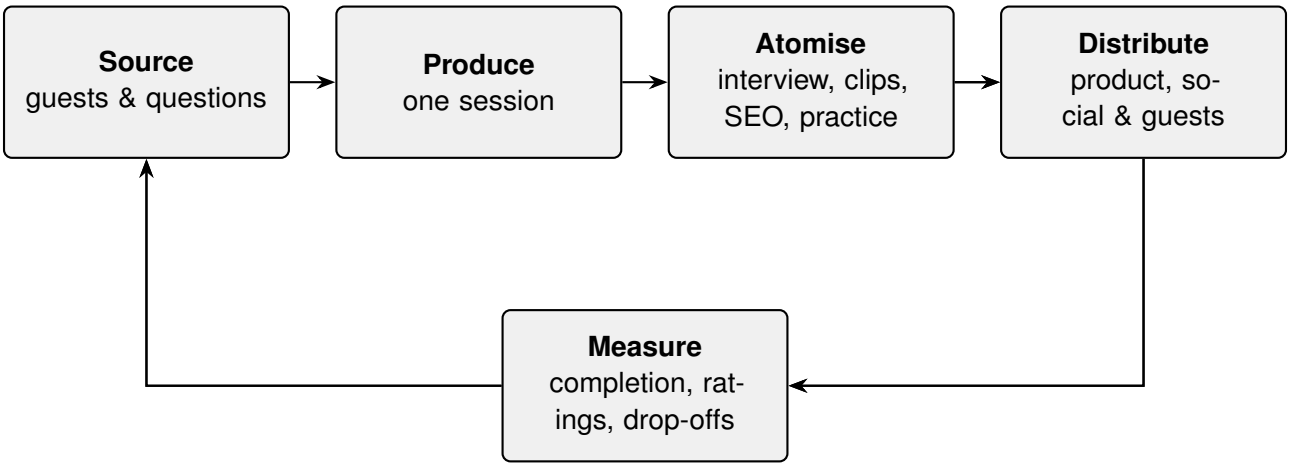
7. Content and Credibility Strategy

Trust is the real moat. A single generic or promotional interview damages the credibility of every other interview. I use four pillars.

Pillar	What we do
Verified	Guests are verified for identity, current or recent role, and relevant professional background using publicly available sources. A "Verified practitioner" badge and a short bio sit above every interview.
Specific	A fixed, repeatable format: (1) background, (2) relevant interview or product questions, (3) how the guest approaches them, (4) common mistakes, (5) one actionable tip. No generic advice.
Independent	A mix of hiring managers, recent hires and career switchers. Sponsored or company-affiliated content is clearly labelled.
Accountable	A post-interview rating ("Was this useful?" and "Would you trust this advice?"), a visible "last reviewed" date, and an errata note when advice goes out of date.

Quality scorecard (applied before publishing; target at least 8 out of 10): guest relevance, specificity of examples, rubric clarity, audio and video quality, and how well the interview maps to a role and level. Interviews that miss the bar are cut into clips or not published.

The sustainable content loop



Why this scales. One recording session yields roughly one interview, five or six clips, one newsletter section, one SEO page and three to five practice questions, so the cost per learning asset falls. Drop-off curves and ratings show which guests and questions to repeat, and user-submitted questions remove guesswork about what to cover. Guests come from alumni, the community and referrals from past guests.

8. Key Metrics

North star: Weekly Returning Interview Learners (WRIL). It focuses on meaningful repeat engagement. I deliberately avoid raw views, which autoplay and clips can inflate.

Stage	Metric	Hypothesis target
Discovery	Share of new users who open an interview in their first 7 days; click-through on the shelf and in-lesson links.	Baseline first, then +30% in 60 days
Activation	Share who watch at least 60% of an interview; share who start a practice attempt after watching.	40% or more watch; 25% or more practise
Retention	Week-4 retention of interview users compared with non-users; repeat interview learners per month.	Interview users retain 1.5x the rate of non-users.
Credibility	Post-interview rating; “would trust this advice” score; share of interviews rated 4 or above.	4.3 out of 5 or more; 80% rated 4 or above
Loop health	User-submitted questions per 100 weekly active users; clip-driven sign-ups; practice completion rate.	Rising week on week
Business	Interview-to-paid conversion rate; cost per interview; cost per weekly interview learner (new and returning).	Conversion up; cost per weekly interview learner falling

Guardrails: overall completion rate, content quality scores, learner NPS and production cost per interview must not worsen while growth metrics improve. **Causality note:** interview users may retain better simply because they were more motivated to begin with, so I would confirm any retention claim with a holdout group (experiments E1 and E4 below) before presenting it as impact. All targets are illustrative until a baseline exists.

9. Prioritised Initiatives and Experiments

I scored ideas qualitatively with RICE (Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort), then asked a second question: **does this strengthen the core loop?**

Initiative	R	I	C	E	Decision
Post-interview practice prompt (L1)	High	High	High	Low	**Do first**
Role-based interview shelf	High	Med	High	Low	**Do first**
Verified-guest badge and “What they actually asked” card	Med	High	High	Low	**Do first**
Weekly series with reminders (L2)	Med	High	Med	Med	**Next**
Clip distribution and guest kit	High	Med	Med	Med	**Next**
Community question voting (L3)	Med	Med	Med	Med	**Next**
SEO pages per company and question	High	Med	Low	High	Later
Heavy gamification and badges	Low	Low	Low	Med	Not now
AI-generated interviews	Med	Low	Low	High	Not now

What I would deliberately not do: generate synthetic AI “interviews” before the core credibility model is proven (they introduce significant trust risk without addressing the highest-priority user problem), put everything behind a paywall (it would hurt discovery), or add broad gamification before the core loop is proven.

Top experiments

Experiment	Hypothesis	Design	Ship or kill rule
E1. Practice prompt	Ending each interview with the same question increases return visits.	A/B test: 50% see the prompt, 50% do not; 2 weeks.	Ship if practice starts reach 20% (minimum to ship; goal 25%) and 7-day return improves. Kill if completion drops.
E2. Role-based shelf	A personalised shelf beats a chronological list.	Ask for the target role at onboarding; shelf versus default; 2 weeks.	Ship if interview opens within 7 days rise by 20%.
E3. Credibility card	A verified badge plus a “What they actually asked” summary raises trust and completion.	A/B test on the interview page, plus a short trust survey.	Ship if completion rises 10% or the trust score rises 0.3.
E4. Weekly cadence	A fixed weekly release plus a reminder builds a habit.	Cohort test on one series for 6 weeks, with a control group.	Ship if week-4 retention improves by 5 points over control.
E5. Clip formats	Clips that open with a real question beat highlight reels.	Three clip styles from the same interview; track click-through and sign-ups.	Double down on the best style.

10. Execution Plan, Economics and Risks

30/60/90-day plan

Phase	Focus	Outputs
Days 1 to 30	Baseline and quick wins. Instrument the funnel; hold 8 to 10 user conversations; analyse drop-offs; launch E1 to E3.	A dashboard for WRIL and the funnel; the standard interview template; the first verified-guest cards.
Days 31 to 60	Habit. Launch the weekly series and reminders (E4); start the guest kit and clips (E5); open community questions.	Four consecutive weekly releases; first clip-driven sign-up data.
Days 61 to 90	Scale. Add SEO pages for the top 10 company and question clusters; formalise the guest pipeline; review the economics.	A content-engine playbook; cost per interview and per weekly interview learner; a decision on what to scale.

Ownership: I would drive the initial rollout with the design and content leads, with weekly review of experiment results and priorities with the founders.

Economics (founder's-office lens)

The feature earns its place if the value it creates exceeds what it costs to run:

$$\text{Monthly Content Cost} < (\text{Extra Paid Conversions} \times \text{ARPU}) + \text{Retention Value of Interview Users}$$

This is why I track **cost per weekly interview learner (new and returning)** and **interview-to-paid conversion** alongside engagement. Reusing one recording session across many assets (Section 7) is the main lever for keeping cost per weekly interview learner low. The inputs are not known to me, so the first review in week 12 would use real numbers.

Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Guest supply dries up	Build a pipeline from alumni and past guests; offer visibility and a co-branded clip kit as the incentive.
Quality drifts as volume rises	Scorecard gate before publishing; fixed format; monthly review of ratings.
Views rise but learning does not	Optimise WRIL and practice completion, not raw views.
Production cost outpaces value	Track cost per weekly interview learner; reuse each session across many assets.
Cannibalising paid courses	Keep full interviews open, but place practice feedback and path tracking behind sign-up or paid tiers; track interview-to-paid conversion.

What I would validate first. (1) Where users drop off in the current interview flow. (2) What learners say they want to do **right after** watching. (3) Which kinds of guests they trust most. These three answers can change the priorities above, which is why the first 30 days are about learning before scaling.